



Getting ready for your DVA claim

DefVetBridge | prepared 01/10/2026 | fill in on screen, or print and write

Two things get your claim moving: your records, and a few details that are not in them. DefVetBridge reads your records, finds what supports each condition, and fills in the DVA forms. Nothing is sent to DVA until you lodge your claim yourself.

1. Get your Defence records

Your service record, health (medical) record, psychology and incident records.

- **Have ready:** 2 certified proof of identity documents (one photo ID, one other), your Service or PMKeyS number, and the year you discharged.
- **Fastest way:** ServiceConnect, using the myID app at 'Standard' strength. Choose My Service Records, then 'Start a request'. Records arrive by email as a secure download link.
 - [ServiceConnect: how to sign in](#)
 - [Step-by-step help guide for a records request in ServiceConnect \(PDF\)](#)
- **If you cannot use ServiceConnect:** some ServiceConnect services need a Defence email address, so former members may not get in. Use the Defence website form instead: you send certified ID, and your records come by post on an encrypted USB.
 - [Defence personal information request form](#)
- **What to ask for:** ask for your complete health record, service record, psychology records and any incident reports. Defence aims to respond within 30 days.
- **Someone helping you?** your advocate can request your records for you, with your certified ID and a consent note you sign. The wording is on Defence's page:
 - [Defence: personal information requests \(who can ask, what you need\)](#)
- **Help:** 1800 333 362 (1800 DEFENCE).

2. Get your DVA records (only if you have claimed before)

Decision letters, accepted conditions and reports on your DVA file. A separate request from Defence.

- **Check first:** MyService shows your accepted conditions and the progress of any claim.
- **Need more:** a Personal Information Request (PIR), online or by email to Information.Access@dva.gov.au. The quickest way to get your DVA file. Free; DVA aims to respond within 30 days.
 - [DVA: personal information requests](#)
- **Formal route:** a Freedom of Information (FOI) request, when a PIR does not give you everything, when you want a formal decision you can have reviewed, or to correct wrong information on your file. Put it in writing, say it is an application under the FOI Act, and describe the documents you want. Use DVA's webform, or the Information Access Application form (D8601) by email to Information.Access@dva.gov.au or post to Information Access Unit, DVA, GPO Box 9998, Brisbane QLD 4001. Acknowledged within 14 days, decided within 30 (DVA can extend it). No charge for your own personal information.
 - [DVA: freedom of information requests \(webform\)](#)
 - [Information Access Application form D8601 \(PDF\)](#)
- **Help:** 1800 VETERAN (1800 838 372).

3. Upload them to DefVetBridge

- Upload every file as it arrives, scans and photos included. DefVetBridge reads handwriting, finds your conditions and links each one to the pages that support it. Then fill in page 2.

Since 1 July 2026 every new DVA claim is made under the Military Rehabilitation and Compensation Act (MRCA), whenever and wherever you served. DefVetBridge organises evidence; it is not legal or medical advice.

Your details: the few things your records do not hold

Fill in what you know, leave the rest blank, and give it to your advocate or upload it to DefVetBridge. Bank details and signatures are not asked for: you add those yourself on the DVA form.

4. About you

Title ☐ Mr ☐ Mrs ☐ Ms ☐ Miss ☐ Dr

Gender ☐ Male ☐ Female ☐ Gender X

Other title

DVA file number (if you have one)

5. Contact details

Residential address

Suburb / town

State

Postcode

Mobile

Email

Postal address ☐ Same as residential

Postal address (only if different)

Postcode

6. Next of kin

Name

Relationship to you

Phone

7. Conditions DVA has already accepted

Leave blank if you have none.

- **Where to find them:** in MyService (through myGov), select Your information, then Accepted conditions. Each is listed with the Act it was accepted under and its date of effect.
- **Easiest:** print that page or save it as a PDF and attach it, or upload it to DefVetBridge, instead of filling in the table. A copy of your DVA decision letters works too. No MyService? Call 1800 VETERAN (1800 838 372) and ask for a list.
 - [DVA: how to find your accepted conditions in MyService](#)

Accepted condition

DVA reference / claim number

DVA card ☐ Gold ☐ White ☐ None

8. Your GP

GP's name

Practice

Phone

9. Advocate (if you have one)

Name

Organisation

Phone

10. Other payments you receive

☐ Centrelink ☐ CSC / MilSuper ☐ Comcare ☐ Workers' comp or insurance ☐ None

Reference numbers (if known)

That is all we need from you. Your service history, medical history and the conditions to claim come from your records.